Welcome to Stamp Album Generator 2



A practical guide to collecting, reviewing, and generating stamp albums

Stamp Album Generator 2 gathers stamp data in a country or theme database, lets you review records, and creates album instructions for AlbumEasy. This guide explains setup, data collection, review, and output.

AlbumEasy is a separate application by Bundu Technology Ltd. Install it to lay out pages and create PPDF s s. When configured, Stamp Album Generator 2 can launch it. Review the generated text and add commands you need.

1. First-time setup

This program is a self contained application. All support files needed are installed after the first run of the application. including the desktop icons in both Linux and Windows

1. Start the Review UI with stamp_album_gen2 --review-ui (on Windows, use stamp_album_gen2.exe).

2. On the startup page, choose and apply the Albums Root folder. You can change it later.

3. Select a collection and choose Open Review. To start one, choose Create New Country or Theme, enter a name, and select Create & Initialize.

4. If needed, save your StampWorld or Colnect login in Site Accounts. Credentials are kept in local config.toml; keep this file private.

2. Collect data

StampWorld

Use StampWorld Pull on the startup or Review page. Choose the year range and start the pull. If the suggested country URL is wrong, enter and save the correct StampWorld country-page URL. This changes the source page, not the collection name.

Colnect

Import a Colnect CSV from the startup page or Review UI, using Colnect's Export for AlbumEasy format. Inbox imports skip successful files by SHA-256 checksum and do not generate pages unless requested. Auto-route moves files into country sub folders; leave it off to keep them in place.

Other sources include US1847 and saved HTML (extractfile; --source-file is a shortcut). Check --help for requirements for other source values.

3. Review and update records

Compare existing records with candidates. Inspect proposed matches, select the changes you want, and apply them. Check edits before saving; back up the database before making large batches of changes.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER - Replace this note with a screenshot of the startup page, showing the country selector and Albums Root controls.

4. Generate album pages and PDF s

Use the startup page or Review UI generation controls after importing or reviewing data. Output uses the selected database and settings. Inspect the AlbumEasy text before printing. PDF creation needs AlbumEasy; set albumeasy_cli_path for automatic launch, or open the text in AlbumEasy yourself.

Existing output is not overwritten by default. Before allowing an overwrite, back up any edited text, images, or PDF s.

5. Useful command-line examples

Generate from an existing database: stamp_album_gen2 --db-path "Albums/Canada/Canada.db" --album-name "Canada"

Pull StampWorld data: stamp_album_gen2 --source stampworld --site-name "South Korea" --album-name "South Korea" --start-year 1970 --end-year 1980

Process an inbox and generate after successful imports: stamp_album_gen2 --source colnectexport --colnect-inbox "colnect_inbox" --colnect-generate-after-import

Inbox mode only imports unless you add --colnect-generate-after-import. Run stamp_album_gen2

--help for all options. Quote names and paths that contain spaces.

6. Configuration and file safety

Local config.toml stores settings such as the Albums Root, Colnect inbox, AlbumEasy command path, PDF options, and credentials. Create it from config_template.toml or run stamp_album_gen2 --init-config; --force-init-config backs up an existing file. Keep credentials private and back up databases and edited output before changing data.

7. Troubleshooting

No collection? Check Albums Root and select Refresh. Pull or import failure? Check the country, year range, account access, file path, and CSV format; read the status message and log. No PDF? Check AlbumEasy and albumeasy_cli_path. Consult README.md, docs/CLI_USAGE.md, and docs/guides/CONFIG_PARAMETERS_INVENTORY.md for more help.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER - Replace this note with a screenshot of the Review page, including the StampWorld pull and album generation controls.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER - Replace this note with a screenshot of the Colnect import workflow. Remove all placeholder notes before exporting the final PDF.

Acknowledgement: Stamp Album Generator 2 builds on AlbumEasy by Bundu Technology Ltd. Learn more at https://www.thestampweb.com/albumeasy.